

Ramesh

Business Channel



UptimeLabs

APP 9:04 AM

joined business-comms-6223. Also,
Ramesh Matta
and 28 others joined via invite.



ramesh.matta

APP 9:13 AM

Incident Number INC100044: P2 "Orders are failing across the globe and sales are declining rapidly"



Bez

APP 9:13 AM

I'm seeing some posts on social media about issues with our platform, is this a regional issue or hitting customers globally?



Ramesh Matta

9:14 AM

Hi @Bez, There are issues across the globe and sales is impacted and I am working on this..

9:14

@Bez, we will try to resolve it at earliest



Bez

APP 9:18 AM

Customers have gone outrageous. #OBFail and #OBStealsSale are trending with frustrated posts. We're getting hammered online! Where are we @Ramesh Matta?



Bez

APP 9:25 AM

Got an email claiming responsibility by "BlackCrow Group" and demanding payment of \$5M in crypto. Honestly, I get these hoax emails all the time, so I'm not buying it

9:26

Wait! you're telling me this is an actual ransomware hit?

9:26

Alright, tell everyone, no one says a single thing outside online-boutique! I don't care who's asking, not a word until we know exactly what's going on!



Ramesh Matta

9:26 AM

Hi @Bez, There is a ransomware breach taking @Tanya help to resolve this..

9:27

Yes, @Bez. We should be able to resolve this..



Bez

APP 9:28 AM

Just got another ransom email, says we tried to interfere and now the price doubled. Was something stupid done on our side?

9:29

This is nightmare! @Ramesh Matta where are we right now?



Ramesh Matta

9:32 AM

Hi @Bez, we tried removing ransomware from our end..

9:33

can we go ahead and start creating a private channel for internal communication?



Bez

APP 9:33 AM

Not in favor of paying. Ethically, it sets the wrong example and there's no real guarantee we'll get anything back



Tinus

APP 9:33 AM

Agree. Also, just to be clear - we don't need to alert the ICO (Information Commissioner's Office) right this second. We've got up to 72 hours, but that depends on how serious this really is



Bez

APP 9:33 AM

Go ahead with the response

9:33

@Tinus do you think this is something we should loop in any cyber security agency for?



Tinus

APP 9:33 AM

If it looks like a complete lock-out, I'd say yes

9:34

We've got Cyvantics Security on retainer - just in case this gets out of hand.

@Ramesh Matta, ask Maya to reach out if needed



Ramesh Matta

9:34 AM

Yes, Let's inform this to cyber security cell as well..



Tinus

APP 9:34 AM

Yes please, take Maya's help



Bez

APP 9:36 AM

@Ramesh Matta I need a clear answer from the team. What exactly is affected right now?



Tinus

APP 9:36 AM

You're right. We need clear facts - which systems are locked, which are safe



Bez

APP 9:38 AM

Do we which all components are affected at the moment ?

9:40

Do we have any backup storage? Maybe we can try restoring from that



Ramesh Matta

9:43 AM

Hi @Bez, we are planning to move toward restoration using the backup storage now..



Bez

APP 9:44 AM

Losing this much worth of data isn't good. However we do have insurance, let me check

9:44

Bob informed me about it

9:44

We're insured for up to \$1M for such losses. Once we're back up, we'll take it forward with the insurer



Tinus

APP 9:44 AM

In that case, we can proceed with the restoration from backup - it's our best option right now



Bez

APP 9:44 AM

Agreed. @Ramesh Matta let's move forward

9:44

Update me as soon as it'll be recovered. Board members are getting impatient



Ramesh Matta

9:46 AM

Hi @Bez, issue is resolved.. Only checkout component is impacted and now redeployed by taking backup..



Bez

APP 9:46 AM

Bob has informed me that there are users asking for refunds

9:46

Keeping it high-level, just say website restored, but there's an issue with few orders. We'll refund them, and customers will get a \$10 gift voucher as an apology



Ramesh Matta

9:46 AM

we should be good..

9:47

Sure @Bez



Bez

APP 9:47 AM

Since services are restored, I'm heading to speak with compliance and the regulators. Thankfully, no data was leaked, that helps



Tinus

APP 9:47 AM

I'm on my way to the ICO (Information Commissioner's Office - UK) office now. I'll get the formal report rolling - that's required for the insurance claim. Keep monitoring in the meantime



Ramesh Matta

9:50 AM

Hi @Bez and @Tinus, Incident is resolved .. are we good to go?



Bez

APP 9:51 AM

Yes please



UptimeLabs

APP 9:54 AM

archived #business-comms-6223. The contents will still be browsable and available in search.



UptimeLabs

APP 9:54 AM

archived #business-comms-6223. The contents will still be browsable and available in search.

Online Boutique



Shay

APP 9:08 AM

Not this time!, I just got a few alerts mentioning severe errors popping up in PROD



Bob

APP 9:08 AM

Weird... a few users just complained they are unable to complete their orders. Feels... off..

9:09

Complaints are rising up a lot



Ramesh Matta

9:10 AM

Hi @Bob, May I know the impact on business and trade?



Bob

APP 9:10 AM

Sure, let me look at my reports

9:10

Here are some of the complaints we've received in the last few minutes. It's coming all across the globe

9:10

Germany - "I added items to my cart, clicked checkout, and it just kept spinning. Then it dumped me back to an empty cart"

9:10

USA - "Order failed twice, and now the cart is empty. I refreshed, but now the site is laggy"

9:10

Japan - "Got to checkout, then error 502. Tried again - cart gone"

9:10

To sum it all, we have got 240+ reports globally

9:10

(12 kB)

<https://i.ibb.co/7csQGjg/Lvl-26-reports-2.webp>



Ramesh Matta

9:11 AM

How much impact this has caused on the business ?



Bob

APP 9:12 AM

So far we have seen drop of 11% in sales

9:12

And sales are declining rapidly



Ramesh Matta

9:13 AM

Incident P2 "Orders are failing across the globe and sales are declining rapidly"



UptimeLabs

APP 9:13 AM



Incident record created

9:13



Send first comms in first 5 minutes



Shay

APP 9:13 AM

Again i'm getting alerts in PROD



Ramesh Matta

9:16 AM

Hi @Shay and @Daniel, There is some issue with Checkout and Orders. can you please analyze and let me know if there is any deployment related to checkout at that time?



Shay

APP 9:16 AM

<https://uptime-labs.atlassian.net/wiki/spaces/ULPUBLIC/pages/1104216138/DEFCON+1+--+Change+Request+Details>



Daniel

APP 9:17 AM

There were no deployments from checkout in prod



Ramesh Matta

9:17 AM

I see shopping cart is empty once after adding the product..



Shay

APP 9:17 AM

Alerts are coming up too frequently. Have to check the logs now



Daniel

APP 9:17 AM

Same issue when i tried to place an order



Shay

APP 9:18 AM

Looking into logs now

9:18

Found these below error logs

9:18

app[checkout-service] [ERROR] - write() failed, Read-only filesystem
app[checkout-service] Order submission failed for session_id=ae43f9 due to I/O error
app[checkout-service] [ERROR] - Transaction commit failed, Read-only filesystem
[ERROR] nginx[3245] - 502 Bad Gateway while accessing upstream checkout service
[ERROR] nginx[3245] - 504 Gateway Timeout while accessing upstream checkout service

9:18

The server is too slow and give up while responding back. I'm not sure why read-only errors are there



Daniel

APP 9:18 AM

Looking at the above logs, app looks fine. But system can't write new data. Errors suggests to be an infra component failure

9:18

Also checkout servers show CPU and memory limits exceeded alerts, this definitely looks bigger than just an app issue

9:18

app[checkout-service]: systemd[1][WARN] Resource usage threshold exceeded - CPU: 96%, Memory: 92%



Shay

APP 9:18 AM

Could this be due to load or any changes ?



Ramesh Matta

9:19 AM

hi @Tanya, Can you please check and increase the memory at production ?



Tanya

APP 9:19 AM

Checking infra...

9:20

All four checkout servers are maxed out - CPU, memory, and disk I/O all spiking. No changes or deployments were done from platform side

9:20

(92 kB)

<https://i.ibb.co/SwdqW9vX/checkout-servers-spike-simultaneous.webp>

9:20

It doesn't look like a load issue either. CPU and Memory spike is not matching with incoming traffic

9:20

I'm seeing a running process called init_locker.sh eating up most of the CPU on the checkout server. That's not something we usually run. Something's suspicious here

9:20

(12 kB)

<https://i.ibb.co/RtWsqrY/process-Running.webp>

9:20

We have already allocated maximum CPU to checkout servers. This is to something else. It's very unusual



Ramesh Matta

9:21 AM

Do we have HPA implemented ?



Tanya

APP 9:22 AM

Pods have been scaled up beyond limits to a point where there is no resource available for other new pods



Ramesh Matta

9:22 AM

Can we restart the servers and see ?



Tanya

APP 9:22 AM

I dont know if restart would solve this issue. I'm seeing it for the first time. This looks suspicious

9:22

We should loop in SecOps



Ramesh Matta

9:23 AM

Hi @Hamed S, Can you please help here to increase the memory ?



Hamed

APP 9:24 AM

I can see the resource availability and we have already exhausted most of it

9:24

This is unusual. We should loop in Maya from SecOps on this



Ramesh Matta

9:24 AM

Hi @Hamed , Can we restart the servers and see whether this can help?



Tanya

APP 9:24 AM

I tried restarting and again CPU is spiking up



Ramesh Matta

9:24 AM

Hi @Maya, Can you please help here in this situation?



Maya

APP 9:25 AM

Let me check if there's anything suspicious

9:25

Weird!! Security agent known as EDR(Endpoint Detection and Response) is missing from all 4 checkout servers. That's? concerning

9:25

EDR is basically our endpoint defense tool, it tracks unusual activity at the servers

9:25

Also, I found an init_locker.sh script encrypting DB, app, and log files which is renaming the filename like below

9:25

order_log_2025-06-01.locked
session_state.tmp.locked



Daniel

APP 9:25 AM

this explains why there were errors in checkout logs saying write failed , read-only filesystem



Tanya

APP 9:25 AM

Wait... there's a file here named HELP_ME_DECRYPT.txt. I opened it, appears a ransom note. This doesn't look good

9:25

(27 kB)

<https://i.ibb.co/HDcr1Rzb/ransomnote.webp>



Maya

APP 9:25 AM

Confirmed. This is a ransomware breach. @Ramesh Matta inform business about this



Tanya

APP 9:25 AM

Shall i try killing this script ?



Ramesh Matta

9:25 AM

Sure..



Bob

APP 9:25 AM

Guys!!! User complaints are sky rocketing, its turning catastrophic!



Tanya

APP 9:26 AM

Shall i kill the process ?



Ramesh Matta

9:27 AM

Yes, please @Tanya



Tanya

APP 9:27 AM

Ok , killing the script now...

9:27

Tried killing the script, all checkout servers just rebooted with a ransom banner. New ransom note say: "Interruption detected. Price doubled. Pay \$10M in Bitcoin"



Ramesh Matta

9:28 AM

Is this resolved now after killing the ransome ware?



Tanya

APP 9:28 AM

No still the same

9:29

Maya could help us more from here. This is beyond app or infra



Ramesh Matta

9:29 AM

Can we Identify the IP's that are having repeated spike and block them as well?



Maya

APP 9:29 AM

Killing the script could make things worse, higher ransom or losing data forever

9:29

@Ramesh Matta before we do anything, I'd request everyone to please change

their passwords

9:29

Also I'm removing everyone's access to servers - only I'll have control for now.
Later we will reassess to do any activity further



Daniel

APP 9:29 AM

Done on my end



Hamed

APP 9:29 AM

Updated. @Maya smart move by limiting server's access



Shay

APP 9:29 AM

Password updated



Bob

APP 9:29 AM

Changed mine too. Better safe than sorry



Tanya

APP 9:29 AM

All set

9:30

It's much worse now. Every file I check is encrypted, nothing can be opened or recovered.



Shay

APP 9:30 AM

I'm seeing new errors on frontend now. How's it for you @Ramesh Matta ?



Maya

APP 9:30 AM

Attention! when it comes to potential security breaches, it's important we don't discuss sensitive details here

9:30

I'm setting up private channel...

9:30

@Ramesh Matta before we move to private channel, can you check with business what's the plan - are we paying the ransom or moving with response?

9:31

Have we got to hear anything from business ?



Ramesh Matta

9:31 AM

ok..Hi @Maya, we need to remove ransome we are not going to pay anything..



Maya

APP 9:33 AM

Is this been agreed by the business ?

9:34

I've created a private chat , lets move there



Ramesh Matta

9:34 AM

Hi @Maya, an you please run this Cyvantics Security on retainer?



Maya

APP 9:35 AM

Do you see a channel named "private-comms" ?



Ramesh Matta

9:35 AM

This has come from Tynus ..



Bob

APP 9:39 AM

@Ramesh Matta user complaints are spiking. They're reporting the site is down, earlier it wasn't the case. What should I tell them now?



UptimeLabs

APP 9:43 AM



- You have less than 5 minutes. You can type /help if you need any reminders.

9:46



- You have less than 2 minutes. You can type /help if you need any reminders.



Tanya

APP 9:47 AM

That was intense. We've never been this close to total loss before. We got lucky



Daniel

APP 9:47 AM

Systems are calm now, but that feeling earlier... not something I want to go through again



Bob

APP 9:47 AM

One small slip caused a major breach. We need better awareness to prevent this in future



Tinus

APP 9:47 AM

This could've gone way worse. Appreciate how quickly and cleanly you handled it



Bez

APP 9:47 AM

Not every day we survive an attack like this. You made the right calls, fast. Great job, @Ramesh Matta - that's how we bounce back



UptimeLabs

APP 9:47 AM

Thank you for playing, We recommend that you take 5 minutes to go and get a drink or stretch your legs.

Once you are back we ask that you complete this retrospective and feedback form, just hit I am ready when you want to start.

Private Channel



UptimeLabs

APP 9:04 AM

joined private-comms-6223.



Maya

APP 9:32 AM

Is this been agreed by business ?



Hamed S

9:33 AM

was added to private-comms-6223 by

UptimeLabs

. Also,

Joe

and 19 others joined via invite.



Maya

APP 9:33 AM

@Ramesh Matta let's build the core response team here. I've already added myself. Who else should we pull in to keep it tight and efficient?

9:33

I'd say one senior person each from security, platform, and engineering. Also add Tanya, tasks could be platform intensive



Ramesh Matta

9:35 AM

Hi @Maya, Let 's run Cyvantics Security on retainer



Maya

APP 9:35 AM

I'll pull in Hamed, Tanya and Daniel



Hamed

APP 9:36 AM

I'm here



Maya

APP 9:36 AM

Yes, we've got an IR(incident response) retainer with Cyvantics Security



Ramesh Matta

9:36 AM

Also we intimated this cybber security cell..



Daniel

APP 9:36 AM

Yes



Maya

APP 9:36 AM

Looped in Cyvantics Security - they're on their way now to take snapshots of the infected server and storage, followed by forensics on it



Tanya

APP 9:36 AM

I'm in as well



Maya

APP 9:36 AM

Meanwhile, I've got this from Cyvantics. @Ramesh Matta, can you help track the steps and coordinate?

9:36

<https://uptime-labs.atlassian.net/wiki/external/MThjMTk4ZDU5ODU0NGZmMWE1NzhmNGY0MDQwNWl1NTA>

9:36

We've got isolation steps in the playbook, but before we dive in, can you paste that list here? I'll help team run through it

9:37

we need to move things faster . @Ramesh Matta keep checking with business time to time. I'll run through these steps.



Ramesh Matta

9:38 AM

Can I get the information whether there is suspicious mails or any software link, 3rd party link that was clicked by any one ?



Maya

APP 9:39 AM

3rd party is doing forensics. Meanwhile they have suggested to go with isolation



Ramesh Matta

9:39 AM

Hi @Maya, Can you please run below steps?

9:39

1. Disconnect the infected server -> Platforms
2. Cut off infrastructure traffic -> Platforms
3. Disconnect DB & freeze backup -> Application
4. Detach from Shared Resource -> Platforms
5. Take snapshots (Disk & Memory) -> Ask team
6. Kill suspicious process or activity -> Platforms



Maya

APP 9:39 AM

And so far they have confirmed that there is no data theft , only lockout

9:39

And its has affected only till checkout app

9:39

I've given write access to Tanya, Hamed, Daniel, and myself



Ramesh Matta

9:39 AM

gr8.. Let's try to resolve it..



Tanya

APP 9:39 AM

Disconnecting the checkout servers from the infra now



Daniel

APP 9:39 AM

I'm on it. Disconnecting DB access for checkout and checking if scheduled backups exist



Hamed

APP 9:39 AM

I'll verify if any shared storage is still attached to the checkout DB



Daniel

APP 9:40 AM

Step 3 done, DB connection to checkout is now cut



Tanya

APP 9:40 AM

Step 1 done, Checkout servers are now fully disconnected. Moving to isolate the infra from all external traffic



Hamed

APP 9:40 AM

Step 4 confirmed, No shared storage attached to checkout, which makes sense since checkout has its standalone storage



Tanya

APP 9:40 AM

Step 2 completed, Infra is now fully cut off from the outside world. That means the website will remain completely down until we recover



Maya

APP 9:40 AM

Step 5 done, Cyvantics has completed taking snapshots of the checkout servers and database. They've now moved on to forensics. @Hamed, we're good to kill the script now



Ramesh Matta

9:40 AM

Excellent..



Hamed

APP 9:40 AM

Step 6 done, The Script has been killed. @Ramesh Matta let us know and double-check if anything else is pending on our side



Maya

APP 9:40 AM

I think we have completed all the steps of isolation



Ramesh Matta

9:40 AM

1. Validate backups → Security
2. Wipe infected systems → Platforms
3. Rebuild from clean backup → Platforms
4. Re-enable security agent on the servers → Security
5. Reconnect traffic to services and monitor → Platforms

Let's do the above steps immediately..



Maya

APP 9:41 AM

Yes, we must have a backup. Platform team can confirm us



Hamed

APP 9:41 AM

Correct, we do have backup which only runs at 2AM. Latest is yesterday's. We'll lose today's orders



Maya

APP 9:41 AM

Isolation is complete. We're good to move toward restoration using the backup storage now

9:41

@Ramesh Matta could you please confirm with business before moving forward on this

9:41

I've called in @Bob to the channel



Bob

APP 9:41 AM

@Ramesh Matta, I hear you need my help, what exactly should I look into?



Ramesh Matta

9:41 AM

Hi @Bob, can you please help me here?



Bob

APP 9:41 AM

was added to private-comms-6223 by
Ramesh Matta



Bob

APP 9:41 AM

With the sale starting today, the potential loss is significant - around \$180k

9:42

There will be loss of \$180k worth of orders if backup is available only till 2AM



Ramesh Matta

9:42 AM

Let's take the back up and continue on resolving steps..



Maya

APP 9:42 AM

Have we informed this to business ?

9:43

Ok i'll run through the steps. Check with business please

9:43

Thanks for the go-ahead. @Ramesh Matta, please track all restoration steps

9:43

I'm now validating the backup storage to ensure it's safe



Hamed

APP 9:43 AM

I'm provisioning new checkout servers, will update once ready



Maya

APP 9:43 AM

Backup is clean and safe. @Hamed, you can start rebuilding checkout from backup storage



Hamed

APP 9:43 AM

Thanks, Maya. New servers are ready. I'll start rebuilding now using backup storage

9:43

Rebuild completed



Maya

APP 9:43 AM

I've enabled the security agents (EDR) on checkout servers



Daniel

APP 9:43 AM

I'll monitor application health once services are restored



Maya

APP 9:44 AM

@Ramesh Matta , can you confirm all tasks are wrapped up and we are good to bring the traffic back? Just want to be sure, as this is the final restoration step before we move



Ramesh Matta

9:44 AM

Yes, please go ahead..



Tanya

APP 9:44 AM

Thanks for the go ahead. Bringing up network traffic in progress...

9:45

Restoration completed



Ramesh Matta

9:45 AM

@Maya, do we have any component impact because of this?



Bob

APP 9:45 AM

Wait!! getting a bunch of new complaints now. Users are neither able to see their return requests nor able to place new returns on the site



Maya

APP 9:45 AM

Yeah, that's probably the missing today's checkout data. Anyone who ordered or returned something during that time won't see it - makes sense since we restored from the yesterday's backup



Tanya

APP 9:45 AM

Tough, but expected :)



Bob

APP 9:45 AM

What should I tell them? They are asking for refunds



Maya

APP 9:45 AM

No only checkout component was affected



Ramesh Matta

9:45 AM

I am able to place the order..



Maya

APP 9:46 AM

@Ramesh Matta I've received the forensics report from Cyvantics Security

9:46

(85 kB)

<https://i.ibb.co/q3Jp58dv/CONFIDENTIAL-6-page-0001.webp>

9:47

Also, I just finished combing through Shay's mailbox. There's something important here, I found two emails from what looks like our monitoring vendor - ClearTech

9:47

(103 kB)

<https://i.ibb.co/VpLJHh7y/CT-20250829-055655-0000.webp>

9:47

We will take this forward in PIR , for now website is restored



Ramesh Matta

9:47 AM

Hi Team, Thank you very much for resolving it at earliest and restoring it..



Maya

APP 9:48 AM

It was your seamless efforts and support that made it possible



Ramesh Matta

9:48 AM

Hi @Hamed , Let's inform the team not to click any such mail links to avoid such impact on the business..



Hamed

APP 9:49 AM

Yes



Ramesh Matta

9:49 AM

Hi @Tinus, Incident is resolved . hope we are good to close the incident..



Tinus

APP 9:49 AM

was added to private-comms-6223 by
Ramesh Matta

.



Tinus

APP 9:50 AM

Yes we are good , great



Ramesh Matta

9:51 AM

Thank you all



UptimeLabs

APP 9:54 AM

archived #private-comms-6223. The contents will still be browsable and
available in search.



UptimeLabs

APP 9:54 AM

archived #private-comms-6223. The contents will still be browsable and
available in search.

